Getting Started with Landscape

Creating Your First Project

Alpha · March 2026

A quick-start reference for alpha testers covering three paths to your first project.

Introduction

This guide walks you through creating your first project in Landscape. Whether you prefer talking to an AI assistant, filling out a form, or starting from a document upload, Landscape adapts to how you work.

Who this is for: Alpha testers evaluating Landscape for commercial real estate valuation and underwriting workflows.

What you'll learn:

1. The three foundational choices that shape every project
2. **Path A** — Start with Landscaper (conversational, recommended)
3. **Path B** — Create a project manually (form-based)
4. **Path C** — Start from a document upload (extraction-first)
5. How to change your mind — nothing is permanent

> **TIP**
> Every path leads to the same project workspace. Pick whichever fits your situation — you can always switch approaches later.

Section 1: The Three Questions

Every project in Landscape is defined by three choices. Whether Landscaper infers them from your description or you pick them from a form, these three decisions shape your entire workspace.

1.1 What is it? — Property Type

The physical real estate you're analyzing. Property Type determines your data fields, container labels, and which extraction templates Landscaper uses when you upload documents.

Property Type	Use When
Land	Undeveloped land, subdivisions, master-planned communities
Multifamily	Apartments, student housing, senior living
Office	Office buildings, medical office, flex/R&D
Retail	Shopping centers, strip malls, single-tenant retail
Industrial	Warehouse, distribution, manufacturing, self-storage

1.2 How are you looking at it? — Analysis Perspective

Investment — You're evaluating income-producing real estate: buying, holding, operating, and eventually selling. The financial model centers on NOI, cap rates, debt service, and hold-period returns.

Development — You're building something: entitled land, vertical construction, or ground-up development. The financial model centers on development costs, absorption schedules, construction financing, and development profit margin.

> **TIP**
> Pick the one that matches how money flows through the deal. A multifamily acquisition is Investment. A multifamily ground-up build is Development.

1.3 Why are you analyzing it? — Analysis Purpose

Valuation — "What is this worth?" You're forming a market value opinion. The workspace emphasizes the three approaches to value (sales comparison, income, cost), reconciliation, and USPAP-aligned reporting. Debt and equity assumptions aren't required.

Underwriting — "Should we do this deal?" You're making an investment or development decision. The workspace emphasizes returns analysis (IRR, equity multiple, cash-on-cash), capital structure (debt sizing, equity waterfall), and sensitivity testing.

1.4 What Shows Up Where

Your Perspective + Purpose choices control which workspace tabs appear:

Tab	Inv + Valuation	Inv + Underwriting	Dev + Valuation	Dev + Underwriting
Project Home	✓	✓	✓	✓
Property	✓	✓	✓	✓
Valuation	✓	✓	✓	✓
Capitalization	—	✓	—	✓
Returns	—	✓	—	✓
Dev Budget	—	—	✓	✓
Documents	✓	✓	✓	✓
Landscaper AI	✓	✓	✓	✓

Valuation purpose gives you a focused workspace. Underwriting adds the financial structuring tools. Development perspective adds the budget.

1.5 Value-Add Toggle

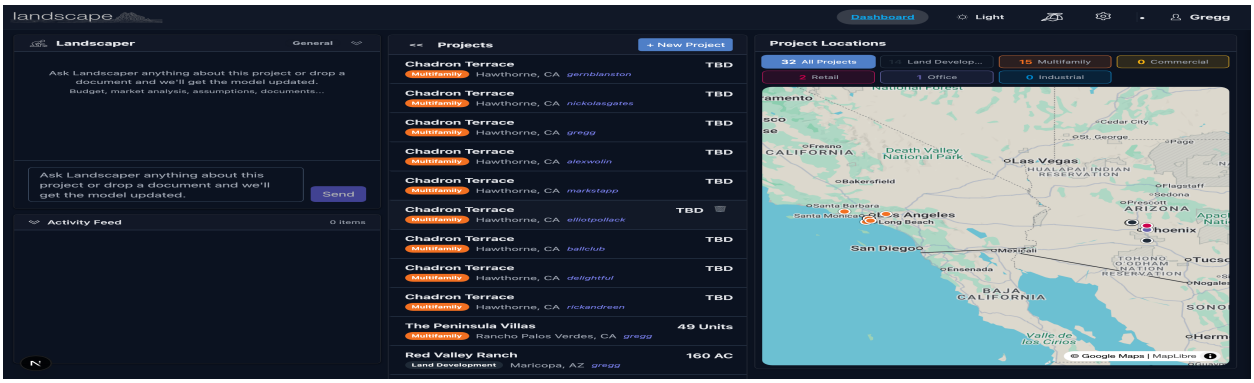
If you chose Investment perspective, you'll see an "Include renovation/value-add analysis" checkbox. Turn this on if the deal involves renovation or repositioning — it adds a Renovation sub-tab under Property where you can model CapEx, unit upgrades, and post-renovation rent projections. You can turn it on or off at any time without losing data.

Section 2: Path A — Start with Landscaper

RECOMMENDED Describe your deal in plain English. Landscaper figures out the rest.

Step 1: Open Landscaper

From the Dashboard, locate the Landscaper panel on the left side of the screen. You'll see a chat interface with a text input at the bottom and a file upload dropzone.



Step 2: Describe Your Deal

Type a description of your deal. You can be as brief or as detailed as you want:

> *"I'm looking at a 96-unit apartment deal in Tempe."*

Or more detailed:

> *"Let's start a new apartment underwriting. Located at 8700 E. Camelback Road in Scottsdale, AZ. 100 units averaging 1,050sf. Average rent $1,500/month. Assume 5% vacancy. Going in cap of 5% with 60% debt at SOFR+3%, 7 year term, 20yr am."*

2

Landscaper chat showing a typed project description in the input field

Step 3: Answer Follow-Up Questions

Landscaper parses what you gave it and asks targeted questions about what's missing. It won't ask about anything you already told it, anything it can look up (current SOFR rate, property tax rates), or what property type it is when you already said "apartment."

NOTE

What Landscaper asks depends on what you provide. If you gave it debt terms, it won't ask again. If you said "market-level expenses," it'll propose specific numbers and ask you to confirm.

3

Landscaper asking targeted follow-up questions based on missing deal parameters

Step 4: Review the Summary

Once Landscaper has enough information, it presents a summary with key metrics: NOI, value conclusion, returns (IRR, equity multiple), and DSCR. Review the numbers before proceeding.

4

Landscaper summary card showing NOI, value, returns, and DSCR metrics

Step 5: Save as Project

When you're satisfied with the initial analysis, Landscaper offers to save it as a full project. Click to confirm, and you'll land in the project workspace with all your data pre-populated across the relevant tabs.

5

Save confirmation dialog — Landscaper creates the project and opens the workspace

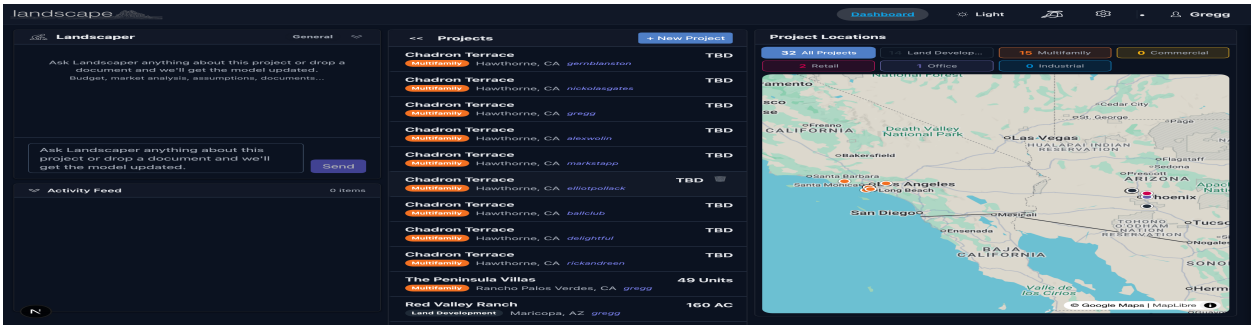
> **TIP**
> You can keep refining in conversation at any time. Landscaper updates the project data directly — "Set vacancy to 7%", "What's the DSCR at these debt terms?", "Run a sensitivity on exit cap rate from 5% to 6%."

Section 3: Path B — Create a Project Manually

This path is faster if you already know exactly what you're building and want to get straight to the input forms.

Step 1: Click New Project

From the Dashboard, click the **"+ New Project"** button in the top-right area. This opens the Create Project modal.

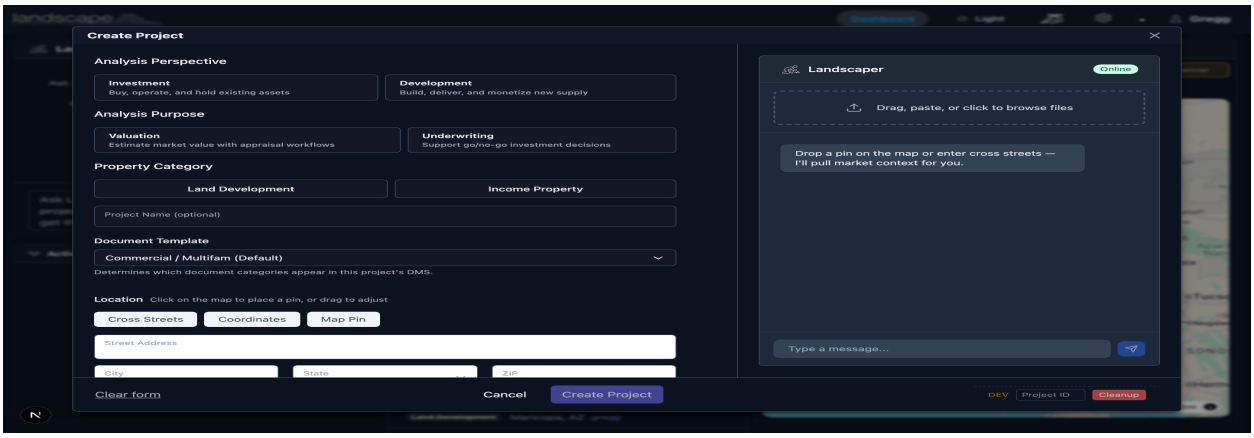


Step 2: Answer the Three Questions

The Create Project modal presents the three foundational choices at the top of the form:

1. **Analysis Perspective** — Choose Investment or Development
2. **Analysis Purpose** — Choose Valuation or Underwriting
3. **Property Category** — Choose Land Development or Income Property, then select the specific Property Type from the dropdown

If you select Investment, you'll also see the "Include renovation/value-add analysis" checkbox below the Purpose selection.



Step 3: Set Property Details and Location

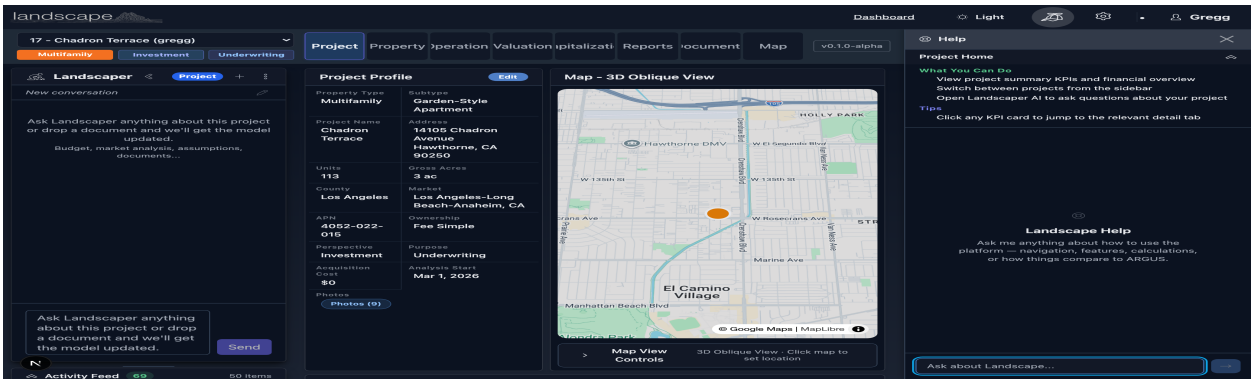
Below the three questions, the form includes optional fields for Project Name, Document Template selection, and the Location section. You can enter a full address, cross streets, coordinates, or drop a map pin. Landscaper appears on the right side of the modal and begins pulling market context as soon as it detects a location.

3

Lower portion of Create Project modal — address fields filled, map pin placed, Landscaper on right acknowledging the location

Step 4: Create and Enter Workspace

Click **"Create Project"** at the bottom of the modal. Landscape validates the required fields (property type and location at minimum), creates the project, and drops you into the project workspace. The tabs visible depend on your Perspective + Purpose choices — see the tab matrix in Section 1.



> **NOTE**
> If Landscaper is active in the Create Project modal, it will respond to your location and start gathering market context before you even finish the form.

Section 4: Path C — Start from a Document Upload

Start from a document — an offering memorandum, rent roll, T-12, or appraisal — and let Landscaper extract structured data to pre-fill your project.

Step 1: Upload During Project Creation

In the Create Project modal (or from the Landscaper panel on an existing project), drag a document into the upload dropzone. Landscaper accepts PDFs and images (JPEG/PNG). Word and Excel files should be converted to PDF first for best results.

1

Create Project modal with a document being dragged into the Landscaper dropzone area

Step 2: Choose Structured Ingestion

After the file is dropped, an Intake Choice modal appears. Select "Structured Ingestion" to trigger the full extraction pipeline. The file uploads and the Ingestion Workbench opens.

2

Intake Choice modal — user selects Structured Ingestion to trigger extraction

Step 3: Review in the Ingestion Workbench

The Ingestion Workbench is a split-panel modal: Landscaper chat on the left (380px), field review table on the right. Landscaper extracts data from your document and presents each field with a confidence

indicator:

- **Accepted** (green) — High confidence, likely correct
- **Pending** (yellow) — Needs your review
- **Conflict** (orange) — Extracted value differs from existing data
- **Waiting** (gray) — Still processing
- **Empty** (light gray) — Not found in the document

3

Ingestion Workbench split panel — Landscaper chat on left, extraction fields with status badges on right, organized by tab (Project / Property / Operations / Valuation)

Step 4: Edit and Approve Fields

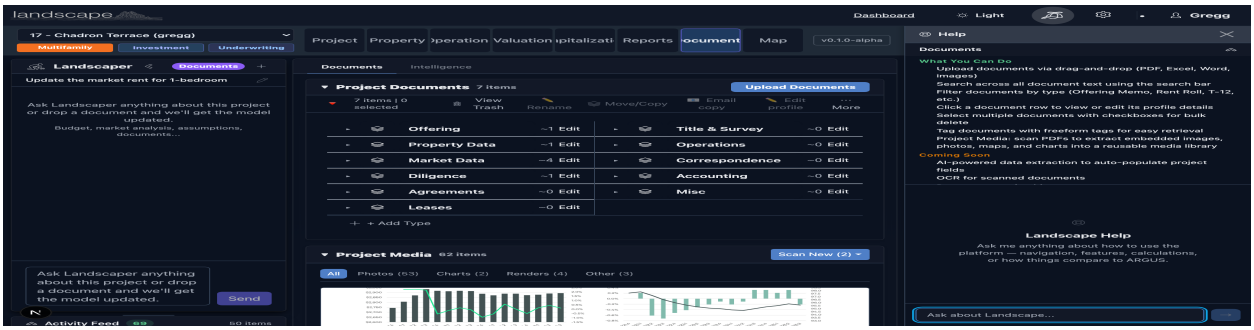
Click any field to edit the extracted value. You can also chat with Landscaper to ask about specific fields — "What does the rent roll say about unit mix?" or "Explain why this value was extracted." Use the tile tabs at the top to filter fields by category (Project, Property, Operations, Valuation, or All).

4

Editing a field value in the Workbench — click to modify extracted data before committing

Step 5: Commit to Project

Once you've reviewed the extracted fields, click Commit. The values are written to the project tables, a DMS record is created, and the workbench closes. Fields populated from the document show a data provenance indicator (lock icon) so you can always trace where a value came from.



IMPORTANT

PDFs work best for extraction. Clean native PDFs outperform scanned documents. If extraction returns empty results, try re-uploading a cleaner version of the document.

Section 5: Nothing is Permanent

Your Perspective and Purpose choices can be changed at any time in the project profile. Landscape adjusts the visible tabs instantly. No data is lost when you switch — the data stays in the database, the tabs just show or hide.

Switching from Underwriting to Valuation hides the Capitalization and Returns tabs but doesn't delete your debt and equity assumptions. Switch back and they're still there.

Similarly, all three creation paths feed the same underlying project data. A project started via Landscaper conversation can later receive document uploads. A project created manually can be enriched with Landscaper chat. A document-first project can be refined with manual edits. Mix and match however you work best.

> **TIP**
> There are three ways to add data to any project: upload documents (extraction), talk to Landscaper (conversational AI), or enter data manually (direct edit). All three feed the same project tables.

Quick Reference Card

Choose the path that matches your starting point:

	Path A: Landscaper	**Path B: Manual**	**Path C: Document**
Best for	You have a deal in your head and want to talk it through	You know exactly what you're building and want the forms	You have an OM, rent roll, or T-12 to start from
Start from	Dashboard → Landscaper panel	Dashboard → + New Project	Create Project → Upload dropzone
AI involved?	Yes — Landscaper drives the conversation	Optional — Landscaper assists in the modal	Yes — extraction + Workbench review
Time to project	2-5 min conversation	1-2 min form	3-5 min upload + review
Data accuracy	AI-inferred, user-confirmed	User-entered directly	Document-extracted, user-reviewed

The Three Questions — At a Glance

Question	Choices	What It Controls
What is it?	Land, Multifamily, Office, Retail, Industrial	Data fields, container labels, extraction templates
How are you looking at it?	Investment or Development	Financial model framework, tab availability
Why are you analyzing it?	Valuation or Underwriting	Workspace focus, required outputs, reporting style

Need help? Open the Landscaper panel from any tab and ask. Landscaper is context-aware and can answer questions about your project, uploaded documents, or market data.